

Game Chat Red Flags



BIG IDEA What a person does tells you what is safe. Seeming nice, or being someone you have met, tells you much less. Red flags mean: say no, leave, block, report, and tell.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Red Flag poster (R-0), Scenario Cards (R-6.1: 12 red-flag, 4 green-flag), Exit Script strip (R-6.2), pencils.

- ☐ Hang the Red Flag poster; post the exit script.
- ☐ One card set and script strip per group.
- ☐ Plan to read the red-flag line yourself, flat, like a card.

1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script “Amara, from our squad, builds amazing game worlds. A player she had chatted with for weeks said, ‘You’re so good! Let’s talk on another app, just us. And don’t tell your dad, he won’t get it.’ Amara felt a funny flip in her stomach. The player had been nice. They had even given her some coins. But you do not need to know if a person is ‘good’ or ‘bad’ to know what to do. You just look at what they ask for. Moving to a private app? Keeping secrets? Red flags. Amara said, ‘Not doing that. Bye.’ She blocked the player and told her dad.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN Flag It, Say It

- 1 (1 min) Six flags with signals:** switch apps (hands swap), secrets (finger to lips), gifts (hands cupped), pressure (palms push), personal questions (finger at self), pictures (hands frame).
- 2 (1 min) Exit script,** twice together: “Not doing that. Bye.” Then three air taps: **Block. Report. Tell.** No reason needed.
- 3 (4 min) Scenario cards.** A reader draws one. Red flag or green? What would the squad do? A pair acts out the exit script and the Tell. Three cards per group.
- 4 (2 min) Hot seat.** You read the red-flag line from a card; two volunteers practice only the exit script and the Tell.

FUN BOOST Say It Three Ways. In pairs, say “Not doing that. Bye.” as a whisper, a robot and a cheerful news anchor. The script works in any voice.

LEVEL-UP My Exit Script. Write it in your own words (“Nope. Bye.”) and name the grown-up you would tell. List three green flags of a good gaming buddy.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Is it okay to say no to someone who has been nice or given you gifts?” (Yes. Gifts are never a reason to keep a secret.)
- 2** “What if they say ‘you’ll be in trouble’?” (Pressure. You can still leave and tell.)
- 3** “What are green flags?” (Talking about the game, taking turns, respecting “no,” nothing secret.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Secrets, switching apps and pushy asks make hackles rise. Hackles up is never wrong to say, even if it is a false alarm, and it is never your fault. Red flag? Pause. Check: which of the six? Tell: block, report, tell a grown-up.”

Hand signal: The six flag signals, then “Not doing that. Bye.” with three air taps: Block, Report, Tell.

EXIT TICKET “Write the exit script and name one grown-up you would tell.”

DIFFERENTIATE Use the 8 simplest cards, a reader, and the picture version of the six flags.

FAMILY CARD Tell your child: “You will never be in trouble for telling me about something in a chat.” Ask: “Has anyone in a game asked you to switch apps or keep a secret?”

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell.”
- **Do not say:** “I promise I won’t tell anyone.”
- “Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?”
- Anything beyond “Can you tell me more?”

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.